

Product Sprint

Mutual Fund Hunt

Where Learning Meets Earning for under 30

Created by North Star Duo
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Given Case

Investing Made Fun – Gamify Mutual Funds for Beginners

Context: Apps like Groww, INDmoney, and Zerodha Coin help users invest but it's intimidating for first-timers.

Problem: Create a feature or experience that gamifies mutual fund investing for people under 30, without harming financial literacy.

Goal: Improve first-time investment conversion while retaining trust.

Quantitative research insights

- 62% increase in retail investors aged 18–30 between 2019–2021, driven by app-based platforms like Groww and Zerodha.
- 75% of Gen Z and young adults prefer mutual funds for retirement planning over fixed deposits or insurance.
- 55% of new trading app users are under 30, and 75% are first-time investors
- Apps with gamified features (e.g., progress tracking, rewards) see **3x higher retention** among users under 25 compared to traditional interfaces.



Qualitative research insights

1) Motivations:

- **Fear of Missing Out (FOMO):** Social media and peer comparisons drive initial interest in investing.
- **Low Barriers to Entry:** Small SIP amounts (as low as ₹500/month) and app-based convenience lower intimidation.

2) Barriers:

- **Knowledge Gaps:** 72% of young investors lack awareness of diversification, risk profiling, or tax implications.
- **Trust Deficits:** Many rely on agents/family for guidance due to skepticism about self-directed platforms.



Qualitative research insights (*Continue...*)



3) Gamification Preferences:

- **Progress Visualization:** Interactive dashboards (e.g., "Wealth Mountain" climbs with SIP consistency) boost engagement.
- **Social Validation:** Leaderboards, group challenges, and achievement sharing foster accountability.
- **Safe Experimentation:** Scenario-based simulations (e.g., "What if markets crash?") build confidence without real-money risks.

4) Ethical Concerns:

- Gamification risks encouraging reckless behavior if overly focused on short-term rewards.
- Users demand transparency about fees, risks, and fund performance

User Personas



Riya (The First-Time Earner)

Age – 24

Backgrounds – Junior Designer, recently started earning, lives in metro city

Motivations – Wants to be financially independent and start investing early

Frustrations/Barriers – Doesn't understand mutual fund terms, scared of making mistakes



Tanish (The Peer driven Investor)

Age – 26

Backgrounds – Social media executive, hears friends talking about investing

Motivations – Wants to not feel left out, enjoys gamified experiences

Frustrations/Barriers – Feels apps are boring/confusing, lacks discipline to invest regularly



Mehak (The Curious Learner)

Age – 21

Backgrounds – College student studying Economics

Motivations – Wants to learn investing through experience and experiment

Frustrations/Barriers – No real income to invest, hesitant to risk real money.

User Stories: Walking in Their Shoes

Persona	Age	As a..	I want to...	So that I can...
Riya	24	First-time investor	Learn investing concepts through games	Build confidence before risking real money
Mehak	21	Curious learner	Track progress and earn rewards	Stay motivated to continue learning
Tanish	26	Financial novice	Simulate investing with virtual money	Understand market risks without financial loss

JTBD

1) As a user, I want to understand the basics of mutual fund investing through interactive experiences, so that I can feel confident and informed before putting in real money.

- **Functional need:** Easy-to-understand, step-by-step learning with simulations, visual explanations, or gamified modules.
- **Emotional need:** Feel confident, safe, and in control while learning about something unfamiliar.
- **Social need:** Feel competent enough to discuss investing with peers without feeling left out or uninformed.

2) As a user, I want to start investing with small, low-risk amounts and get instant feedback, so that I can build trust and develop a consistent investment habit.

- **Functional need:** Ability to start SIPs with minimal amounts, real-time feedback on performance or learning outcomes.
- **Emotional need:** Reduce fear of loss, gain early wins that boost confidence and establish habit.
- **Social need:** Be seen as responsible or “on the right track” by peers, even with small steps.

JTBD (*Continue...*)

3) As a user, I want to track my investment journey using levels, badges, or streaks, so that I can stay motivated and see tangible progress as I learn and invest.

- **Functional need:** Clear visual indicators of progress, achievement unlocks, habit tracking.
- **Emotional need:** Feel accomplished, proud, and rewarded for consistency and effort.
- **Social need:** Show or share progress with others, building a sense of identity as an investor.

4) As a user, I want to start investing with small, low-risk amounts and get instant feedback, so that I can build trust and develop a consistent investment habit.

- **Functional need:** Ability to start SLPs with minimal amounts, real-time feedback on performance or learning outcomes.
- **Emotional need:** Reduce fear of loss, gain early wins that boost confidence and establish habit.
- **Social need:** Be seen as responsible or “on the right track” by peers, even with small steps.

A black and white photograph of a hand pouring coins into a glass jar, which is held by another hand. The coins are visible inside the jar and some are scattered on the surface below. The image is partially obscured by a blue circular graphic on the left side of the slide.

Problem Statement

“ Despite rising incomes and digital access, 75% of India’s under-30 population do not invest in mutual funds because:

- Complex jargon and intimidating interfaces make apps overwhelming for first-time investors.**
- Fear of financial loss and mistrust in the markets and platforms prevent action.**
- Traditional financial literacy programs feel disconnected, boring, and impractical, failing to engage young users.**
- Lack of an engaging, supportive learning experience creates a high barrier to entry, leading to hesitation and lost opportunities for wealth creation.**

”



How Might We Make Mutual Fund Investing Fun, Simple, and Trustworthy for Under-30s?

How might We design a gamified, educational, and trustworthy mutual fund investing experience that overcomes the fear, confusion, and boredom first-time young investors face—while preparing them to invest real money confidently?

What the Market Offers—And What It Lacks

Platforms	What they offer	What they lack
	Simple, beginner-friendly UI; easy direct mutual fund investing; free account opening; strong educational content	Lacks deep gamification-no quests, progress tracking, or interactive learning modules for new investors.
	Advanced learning initiatives (Varsity), strong reputation, separate Coin app for mutual funds, robust tools for analysis	Onboarding is not gamified or interactive; learning is text-heavy, which can intimidate beginners.
	Feature-rich platform, 3-in-1 account, mutual fund investment, competitive pricing	Interface is more trading-focused; lacks engaging, gamified experiences tailored for first-time mutual fund investors
	All-in-one app with global and Indian mutual fund investing, financial goal tracking, zero delivery brokerage	No gamified onboarding or interactive education; primarily operates via app, with limited advanced engagement features



Our Opportunity



Below are the Opportunities for Future (OFF)

O.F.F - 1

India's Under-
30 Population
= 50%+

O.F.F - 2

High Mobile
App Usage

O.F.F - 3

Eager to
Learn, But
Crave Fun

O.F.F - 4

White Space
in Gamified
Investing

Product Discovery

01

Mutual Fund Hunt (Gamified Onboarding Journey)

A step-by-step adventure that guides users through their first investment journey. Users unlock goals, complete missions, and level up as they build financial confidence.

02

Social Leaderboards & Group Challenges

Engage users through friendly competition and shared milestones.
Track progress with peers and spark motivation via group investing goals.



03

Simulation Mode (Risk-Free Investing Sandbox)

A no-risk playground where users can try investing with virtual money.
Build confidence by experimenting with SIPs and fund selection—no fear of loss.

Product Discovery (Continue...)

04

Streaks & Consistency Rewards (Habit-building)

Celebrate daily engagement with streak badges and small win rewards.
Build strong investing habits through consistent learning and action.

05

Interactive Quiz-based Learning Modules

Bite-sized, gamified lessons that turn jargon into clarity.
Users earn points and badges for completing quizzes and mastering concepts.



Prioritization - RICE Score

Solutions	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE Score
Mutual Fund Hunt (Gamified Onboarding Journey)	9	8	8	4	144
Social Leaderboards & Group Challenges	7	7	7	5	68.6
Simulation Mode (Risk-Free Investing Sandbox)	6	7	7	6	49
Streaks & Consistency Rewards (Habit-building)	8	6	7	6	56
Interactive Quiz-based Learning Modules	7	6	8	5	67.2

North Star Metrics (NSM)

Input Metrics	What it Measures
Onboarding Completion Rate	% of users who finish the gamified intro journey
Quest Completion Rate	% completing key educational tasks or simulations
Literacy Score Gain	Pre/post concept understanding improvement
Time to First Investment	Speed of conversion after onboarding
Trust Rating	User Confidence in investing after using the prodcut
Retention	Continued useage and exploration after first investment

This metric captures the core value we deliver — helping young users take confident action, not just consume content.

Prototype

01



Welcome to *Mutual Fund Hunt!*

Start your journey to smart investing—
one simple step at a time.

-  No jargon, just guidance.
-  Learn as you go.
-  Safe and secure.

Begin Your Hunt

02

What's your first goal?

Choose a goal to start your investment journey


Emergency Fund


Vacation


New Gadget


Education

Custom Goal

 Setting a goal helps you stay motivated and track progress throughout your investment journey.

Next

03

Find Your Risk Style

Answer these questions to discover your investment personality

How do you feel about ups and downs in your savings?

Very uncomfortable Very comfortable



If your investment drops a little, what do you do?

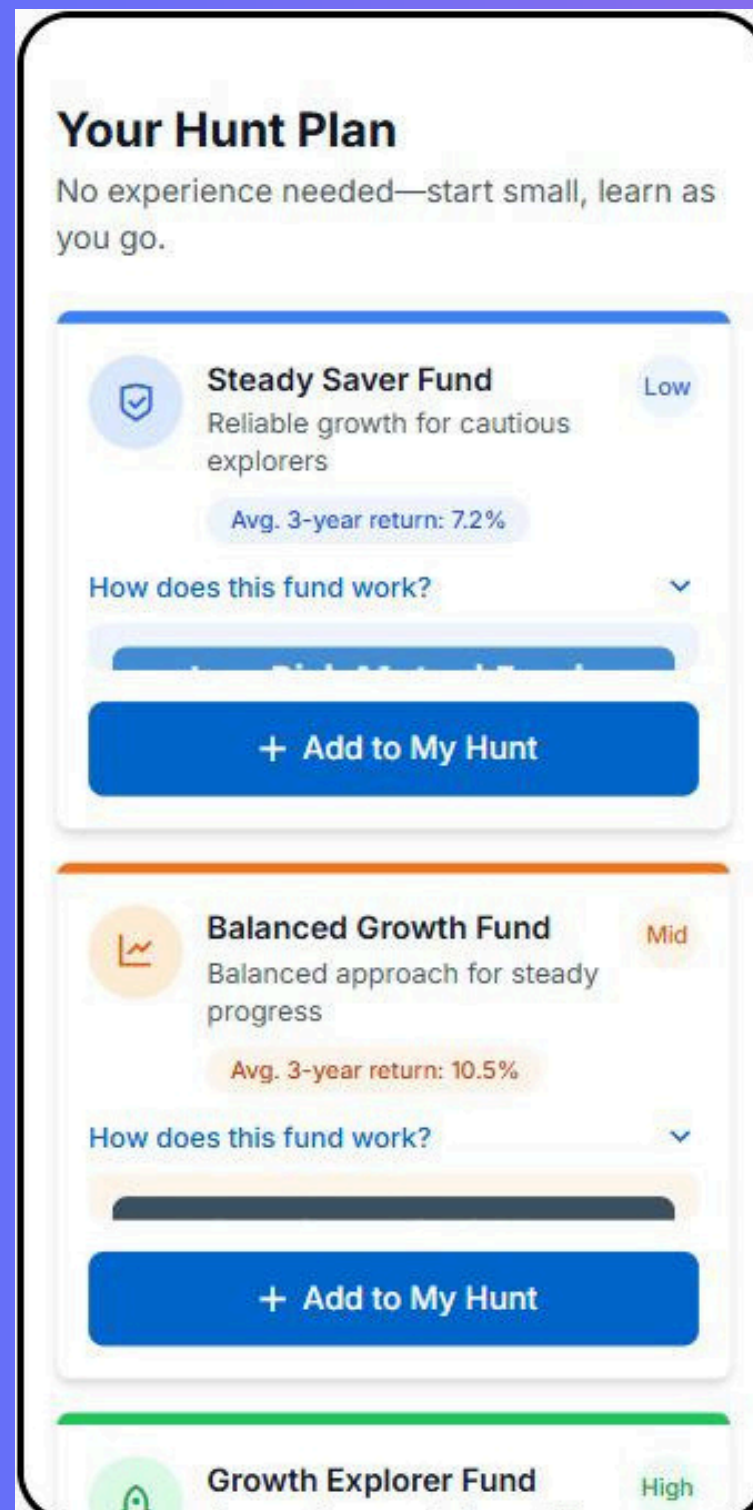
☐ Sell immediately to avoid more losses

☒ Wait and see what happens

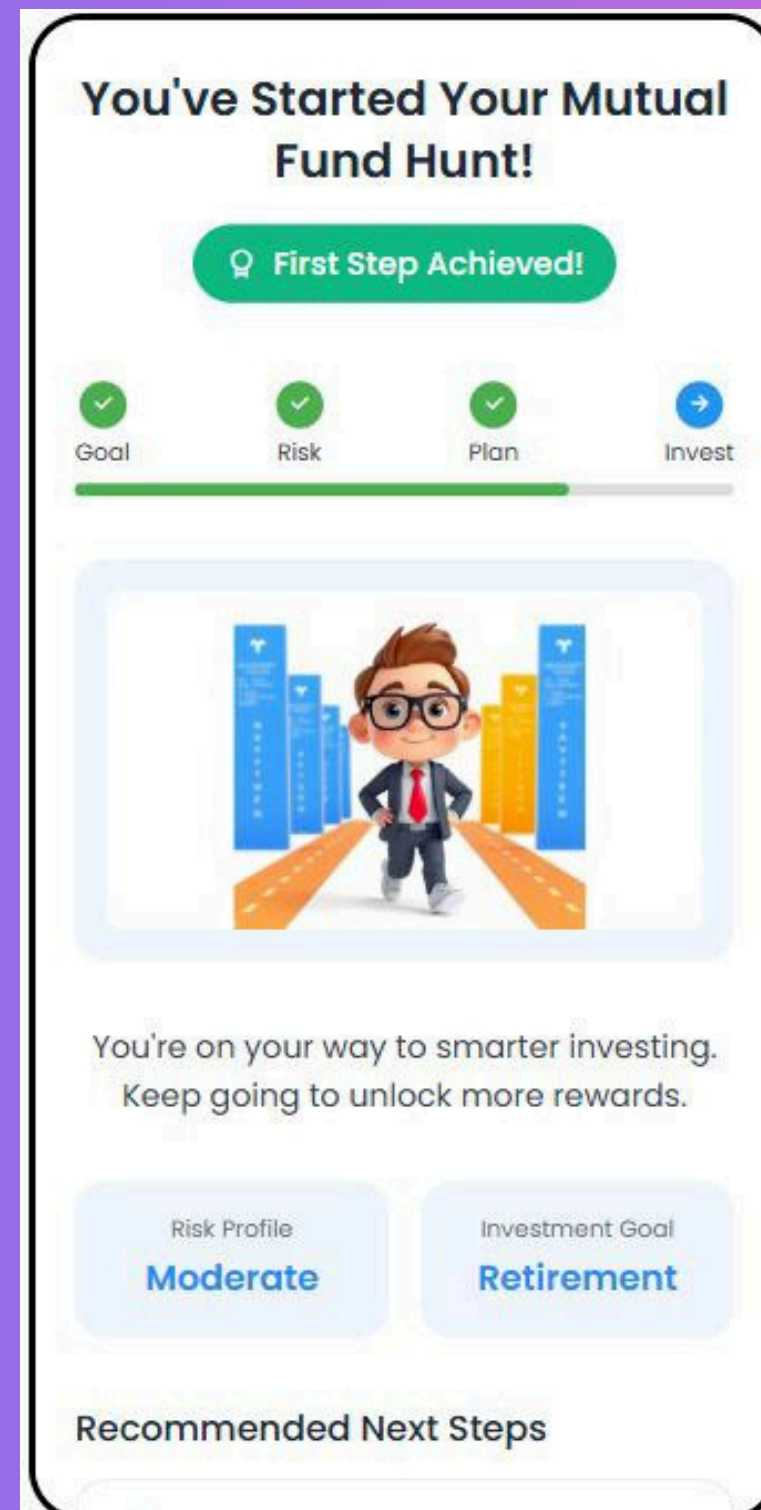
See My Hunt Plan

Prototype (Continue...)

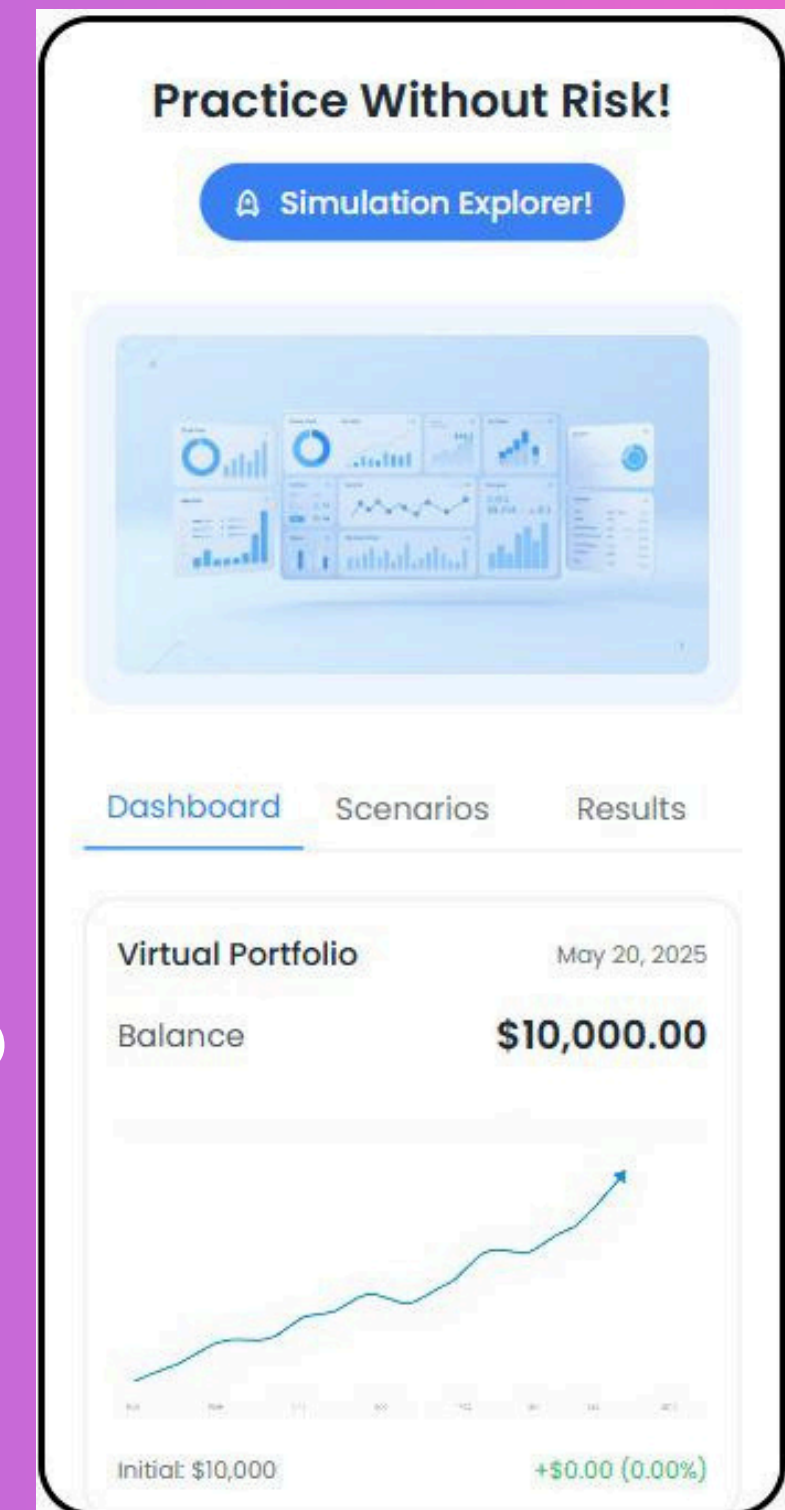
04



05



06



The AARRR stage

Acquisition

Actions: *Social media campaigns, influencer partnerships*

Key metrics : Installs, sign-ups, CTR

Ayesha Bamahdi

Activation

Actions: *Gamified onboarding, first SIP or simulation completed*

Key metrics: Onboarding completion, first investment

Ayesha Bamahdi

Retention

Actions: *Ongoing quests, progress tracking, streaks*

Key metrics: Active users, repeat investments, quest streaks

amahdi

Referral

Actions: *Social sharing, group challenges, referral reward*

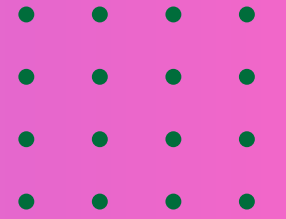
Key metrics: Invites sent, referral sign-ups, social shares

Ayesha Bamahdi

Revenue

Actions: *SIP upsell, premium content, increased AUM*

Key metrics: AUM, average SIP, premium conversion



Thank You

Brought to life by Team North Star Duo — making finance feel familiar, one click at a time.